Petrol strimmer

I complete a practical induction with an experienced member before my first solo use. I must be 18 or over (society rule).

MY FULL NAME

DATE OF MY INDUCTION

MAKE / MODEL / ASSET NUMBER

MY EMAIL

First-aid kit location:

Site address / postcode:

Emergency entrance / access:

USING THIS CHECKLIST

I use the manual, ask questions and practise while the experienced member watches me check, handle, start, use and stop the machine. For each point, I tick Covered (I understand and have covered this), N/A or More help (I need more help). I explain N/A answers and record the task, limits and outcome we agree. If I need more help, I do not use the tool alone until the outstanding points are addressed and recorded.

#	SAFE-USE POINT - on the actual machine	Covered	N/A	More help
	MANUAL			
1	I have read and understood the instructions for this model, with help if needed. I know how to access the manual.			
	PPE			
2	I put on safety glasses and face protection before starting, and check the manual for the protection required.			
3	I wear ear defenders.			
4	I wear gloves, sturdy boots and long trousers. I do not wear shorts or sandals.			
5	I wear close-fitting clothes, tie back long hair and remove scarves, cords or dangling jewellery.			
6	I understand that PPE does not replace safe working methods, and I follow the manual's requirements for my task.			
	BEFORE I START			
7	I am 18 or over (society rule).			
8	I check that the guard is fitted and tight, the line head is secure, the line diameter is correct and the line is no longer than the guard's trimming blade allows.			
9	I never fit a metal blade to a machine that is not built and guarded for one.			
10	I walk and clear the area, and keep people, children and dogs at least 15 m away. I understand that the line can throw stones a long way.			
11	I use only the fuel type and mix specified for this machine, from a clearly labelled can. If I am uncertain, I do not start.			
12	I refuel outdoors with the engine off and cooled, away from ignition sources. I wipe up spills and secure the caps. I start at least 3 m from the fuelling point, or farther if the manual requires.			
13	I understand that the hot exhaust can burn me. I do not rest the machine on dry grass or against my leg.			

Petrol strimmer - continued

#	SAFE-USE POINT - on the actual machine	Covered	N/A	More help
	USING IT			
14	I start on firm ground, with the machine on the ground and the head clear of everything.			
15	If the head turns at idle, I stop and tag the machine OUT OF USE for a competent person to check.			
16	I keep both hands on the handles and the cutting head low, never above waist height. I direct debris away from people.			
17	I feed the line by tapping the head on the ground as designed, never by hand with the engine running.			
18	I do not strim hard against wire, posts or stone, because the line can snap and fly.			
	STOPPING AND RETURNING			
19	I switch the engine off and wait for the head to stop before moving or putting the machine down. Before clearing, cleaning or adjusting, I prevent restart as the manual directs, including disconnecting the spark-plug cap where specified.			
20	I isolate the machine before cleaning. I clean and store it dry as the manual directs, using the recommended methods.			
21	I report any damage or unusual behaviour, tag the machine OUT OF USE and make sure it is logged.			
22	I have had the emergency arrangements explained to me and know how to get first aid and summon help (see 'Using this checklist').			

MY OUTCOME AND AGREED LIMITS

☐ I am ready for the agreed use ☐ I need more help - no solo use

I record the outcome agreed during my induction. If any applicable point needs more help, I do not use the tool alone.

My agreed task / limits / help needed (including reasons for N/A answers):

MY DECLARATION

I have read and understood the machine's instructions, with help if needed, and practised the essentials. I will use the required PPE, follow the agreed limits, stop if unsure and report faults or concerns.

MY SIGNATURE **DATE**

Emergency arrangements: If someone is injured, I stop and make the area safe without putting myself at risk. I get first aid; I call 999 or 112 for serious injury and arrange access for responders. I report accidents and near misses to the Tool Librarian.

I keep this completed record. I revisit my induction after a relevant change, incident, concern or a long gap in use, and ask for further help where needed. Before every use, I check the machine and working area and stop if I am unsure.

For an emailed copy and RVAS Drive storage, I submit my answers through the online form at rvas.co.uk/tool-library/. Submitting a form does not itself authorise solo use. For help or a correction: rvascontact@gmail.com.